

Media

(A Level, OCR)

Does the media we consume shape our ideas and beliefs or merely reflect them? How do media products promote or challenge stereotypes? How do media industries work?

Media Studies A Level is a thorough exploration of the media that pervades our lives - from TV to newspapers; radio to advertising. You will develop a critical approach to the media that surrounds us, gaining not just new perspectives on media including TV dramas, advertising and the film industry, but a fresh understanding of the wider world. You'll use critical theories to explore a variety of global media products, and you'll also get the chance to create your own. By making your own media, you'll develop technical and project management skills that are highly sought after by employers in a range of different fields. This is an A Level that combines theory and practice, analysis and creativity.

This course would pair well with a range of A Levels including English, psychology and sociology as well as with creative subjects such as photography. If you are looking for a lively, relevant and challenging course, A Level Media could be for you. Be warned, however: this will change the way you watch TV forever.

Entry Requirements:

At least a grade 5 in GCSE English.

Course Content

A Level	%	When?	Content
Paper 1: Media Messages	35	June 2028	You will conduct two linked in-depth studies that focus on contemporary news in the UK, exploring how and why newspapers and their online counterparts are evolving as media products and the relationship between both online and offline news. You will also use media theory to explore media language and representation, through the following media forms: magazines, advertising and marketing, and music videos.
Paper 2: Evolving Media	35	June 2028	You will explore media industries and audiences, through media products including radio, video games and film. You will also study two long form television dramas: you will engage in an in-depth study of television as an evolving, global media form. You will study one complete episode of a contemporary English language long form TV drama and one complete episode of a non-English language long form TV drama to inform your study.
NEA:	30	Summer 2027	You will create your own media product from a set brief provided by the exam board.

Costs associated with this course

There are useful course textbooks that will be optional to purchase.

Career Links

The skills you will develop through taking this course are highly sought after by a range of employers. Most obvious are careers in film, TV, journalism and other media, but you will also find it useful for a career in public relations, marketing, teaching or business.

For more information please contact Ms Procter.

